Working research draft

Minimum Determinants of Even Integral Lattices in Ranks Nine and Ten

Applications to Cross-Section Sphere Packings

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English repository edition: 26 October 2026

Mathematical and certificate snapshot: 8 October 2026

Abstract

Motivated by sphere-packing constructions obtained from primitive sections of extremal even unimodular lattices of rank 48, we study determinant minimization for positive-definite even integral lattices with minimum squared norm at least 6. We prove that the minimum Gram determinants in ranks 9 and 10 are 21870 and 54675, respectively, and classify all equality cases. The rank-nine minimizer is unique up to isometry, whereas exactly two isometry classes attain the rank-ten minimum. The proofs combine finite enumeration in exact arithmetic, explicit computational certificates, and a gluing analysis based on $\sqrt{3}E_8$. The rank-ten argument uses the known Hermite bound $\gamma_9 \leq 2$. These results rule out improving the resulting packing densities in dimensions 39 and 38 by choosing smaller-determinant primitive sections, at the packing radius guaranteed by the ambient minimum. For the guaranteed radius in the antipode construction, we further show that nontrivial clusters over rank-nine sections containing $\sqrt{3}E_8$, or over rank-ten determinant minimizers, yield densities strictly below the respective optimal unclustered cross-section densities. The optimality of cluster extensions over arbitrary sections remains open.

Acknowledgements.

I am deeply grateful to Xiaoming Sun and Chengu Wang for our collaboration on *Optimal Extensions of Cross-Sections: Sphere Packings in Dimensions 38 to 43* [2]. The constructions and open questions developed in that work provided the starting point and motivation for the present investigation.

Status and provenance. This working draft was developed through interactive work with ChatGPT, including mathematical exploration, code development, internal checking, and exposition. Exact computational certificates accompany the proofs. Independent external mathematical review and confirmation of scientific novelty remain pending; the results have not been formalized in a proof assistant. This edition reorganizes the recorded results for review and does not assert a new exhaustive computation on its edition date.

Contents

1 Introduction: original problems and main results **2**

2 Notation and general lemmas **3**

3 Uniqueness in rank nine **5**

4 Rank ten with a $\sqrt{3}E_8$ sublattice **8**

5 A rank-nine gap and a preliminary rank-ten bound **10**

6 The global determinant bound in rank ten **11**

7 Cluster extensions: the general geometry **21**

8 No improvement throughout the rank-nine family **22**

9 All diameters for both minimal rank-ten types **23**

10 Verified results for the rank-48 ambient lattices **26**

11 Literature, verification, and remaining problems **30**

A Additional uniform rank-ten cluster bounds **33**

1 Introduction: original problems and main results

1.1 The motivating cross-section questions

The starting point is the manuscript by Ivan Dorofeev, Xiaoming Sun, and Chengu Wang, *Optimal Extensions of Cross-Sections: Sphere Packings in Dimensions 38 to 43* [2]. Its Section 7 asks whether smaller-determinant sections can improve the constructions in dimensions 39 and 38, and whether antipode clusters can give further improvements. We retain these original questions as the organizing motivation of the present work.

Let Λ be an extremal even unimodular lattice of rank 48, with minimum squared norm 6, and let K be a primitive section of rank k. Its orthogonal complement $N = \Lambda \cap (\operatorname{span}_{\mathbb{R}} K)^{\perp}$ has rank $n = 48 - k$ and the same Gram determinant as K. Consequently, at the guaranteed sphere radius $\sqrt{6}/2$, the cross-section packing has center density

$$\delta_0(K) = \frac{(3/2)^{(48-k)/2}}{\sqrt{\det K}}.$$

The determinant is the determinant of a Gram matrix, not the covolume. The original construction realizes sections of rank 9 and determinant 21870, and of rank 10 and determinant 54675. A smaller determinant in the corresponding rank would therefore improve the associated density in dimension 39 or 38.

Every such section is an even integral lattice with minimum squared norm at least 6. This leads to the intrinsic problem

$$e_r(6) = \min\{\det L : \operatorname{rank} L = r,\ L \text{ positive definite, even integral},\ \min L \geq 6\}.$$

Section 7 of [2] leaves the values in ranks 9 and 10 open. Determining these values answers the smaller-determinant questions uniformly, without assuming that the section contains a specified root sublattice or belongs to a particular embedding orbit. The minimizers must then be classified up to integral isometry.

The same source distinguishes these questions from the more general cluster problem. Its unclustered cross-section bounds in dimensions 40, 41, 42, and 43 do not exclude antipode improvements. In dimension 43, the source construction uses a six-point cluster, so its possible further improvement is intrinsically a cluster question. Remark 2 of [2] also asks whether P_{48m} admits an analogous section to those obtained from the fixed lattice $\sqrt{3}(E_8 \perp E_8)$ in the other three specified rank-48 lattices. That question is not resolved here; existence of an arbitrary embedding and realization by a particular order-three automorphism must be distinguished.

1.2 Results and scope

We obtain $e_9(6) = 21870$ with one isometry class of minimizers, and $e_{10}(6) = 54675$ with exactly two. Every rank-ten minimizer has a unique sublattice isometric to $\sqrt{3}E_8$ and exactly three primitive rank-nine sublattices of determinant 21870. The packing consequence is optimality of the corresponding unclustered cross-section densities at the radius inherited from ambient minimum 6. It is not an assertion of global sphere-packing optimality in dimensions 38 or 39.

The proof combines exact finite enumeration with structural arguments for the discriminant classes of $\sqrt{3}E_8$. The global rank-ten search uses the external theorem $\gamma_9 \leq 2$ of [3]. We provide an independent finite-quadratic-module exclusion of the new equality-window boundaries, explicit isometries for the equality cases, and geometric bounds for clusters. Computational certificates and mathematical completeness arguments have different roles: the certificates check the finite data, while the determinant windows, flag argument, and enumeration lemmas explain why the data cover every case in the stated domain.

This text preserves the complete theory and proofs of the reports dated 7 and 8 October 2026, with a new introduction and repository presentation. The companion English report *Rank-nine determinant bound:*

audit and full theory [1] provides the earlier lower-bound proof and its full background. The present text also gives a rank-nine lower-bound route from the complete prefix of the global rank-ten search; see Corollary 6.4. The following table is our organization of the results, not a numbered list copied from the source manuscript.

No.	Question	Established status
1	The exact value of $e_9(6)$ and equality cases	$e_9(6) = 21870$ for abstract even integral rank-nine lattices of minimum at least 6; the sole minimizing isometry class is K_9.
2	The exact value of $e_{10}(6)$	The exact value is $e_{10}(6) = 54675$, and globally there are exactly two equality types, K_{10} and K_{10}^{alt}. Both contain $\sqrt{3}E_8$.
3	Primitive embeddings into specified rank-48 lattices	There are exactly 19 minimal primitive rank-ten supersections of the fixed printed $K_9 \subset P_{48p}$; all have type K_{10}, and none has the alternative type. The embedding orbits of arbitrary copies of K_9 have not been enumerated.
4	Optimality of cluster extensions	Settled for every $\beta < 6$ over every determinant-minimizing rank-ten section. In rank nine, settled for every determinant when $\sqrt{3}E_8$ is present. Appendix A gives further partial bounds for all determinants in rank ten with $\sqrt{3}E_8$. The general problem remains open.
5	The section question for P_{48m} in Remark 2 of the source	Remains open. The printed embeddings audited here do not settle existence of an analogous $\sqrt{3}E_8$-containing section or the specified fixed-lattice construction.
6	External verification and novelty	Separate internal checks and a review of primary sources are completed. No external expert verdict or proof of novelty has been obtained.

In the table, "settled" means that the stated mathematical argument and exact finite certificates cover the specified scope. It does not mean formalization in a proof assistant or independent human refereeing.

2 Notation and general lemmas

2.1 Determinant, minimum, and dual lattice

A rank-r lattice L is generated by a basis in Euclidean space, whose Gram matrix G is positive definite. We write

$$d(L) = \det G, \qquad m(L) = \min_{0 \neq x \in \mathbb{Z}^r} x^{\mathsf{T}} G x.$$

Thus $d(L)$ is the square of the covolume, and $m(L)$ is the squared minimum length. A lattice is integral if all pairings are integers, and even if all squared norms are even integers. In a basis, these conditions are $G_{ij} \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $G_{ii} \in 2\mathbb{Z}$.

The dual lattice

$$L^* = \{y \in \operatorname{span}_{\mathbb{R}} L : (y, L) \subseteq \mathbb{Z}\}$$

has determinant $d(L^*) = d(L)^{-1}$. For integral L, the finite discriminant group $A_L = L^*/L$ has order $d(L)$. Define

$$\mu_L(a) = \min_{y \in a} \|y\|^2, \qquad R_L = \max_{a \in A_L} \mu_L(a).$$

The quantity R_L is the maximum of the minima of the *discrete* classes; it is not the squared covering radius of the entire Euclidean space.

Our object of study is

$$e_r(6) = \min\{d(L) : \operatorname{rank} L = r,\ L \text{ even integral},\ m(L) \geq 6\}.$$

Gram matrices G, G' are integrally isometric if $G' = U^{\mathsf{T}} G U$ for some $U \in \mathrm{GL}_r(\mathbb{Z})$.

2.2 Primitive sections and flags

A sublattice $J \subset L$ is primitive if $J = L \cap \operatorname{span}_{\mathbb{R}} J$, equivalently if L/J is torsion-free. For primitive J, the orthogonal projection P of L onto $\operatorname{span}_{\mathbb{R}}(J)^{\perp}$ is a lattice, and

$$d(L) = d(J)d(P). \tag{1}$$

Indeed, a basis of J extends to a basis of L. The determinant of the block Gram matrix is the determinant of the J block times that of its Schur complement; the latter is the Gram matrix of the projections of the added vectors.

If y is a shortest nonzero vector of L^*, then y is primitive and

$$J = L \cap y^{\perp}, \qquad d(J) = d(L)\|y\|^2 = d(L)m(L^*). \tag{2}$$

Primitivity of y means $(y, L) = \mathbb{Z}$, so the projection onto its line has spacing $1/\|y\|$. The identity follows from (1).

The Hermite constant is defined over *all real Euclidean lattices*:

$$\gamma_r = \sup_L \frac{m(L)}{d(L)^{1/r}}.$$

By (2), consecutive sections satisfy

$$d_{r-1} \leq \gamma_r d_r^{(r-1)/r}, \qquad d_r \geq 6^r/\gamma_r^r. \tag{3}$$

The original proof uses the classical values

$$(\gamma_r^r)_{r=1}^8 = (1, 4/3, 2, 4, 8, 64/3, 64, 256)$$

and Mordell's inequality

$$\gamma_r \leq \gamma_{r-1}^{(r-1)/(r-2)}. \tag{4}$$

The new determinant gap and global rank-ten bound additionally import the public theorem $\gamma_9 = 2$ from [3]. This input is not needed for the new classification at $d_9 = 21870$.

An even integral matrix of odd order has even determinant. In order $2m$, its determinant is congruent to 0 or $(-1)^m$ modulo 4. These restrictions are applied when rounding every determinant window.

2.3 The complete one-step extension criterion

Let J be even integral with $m(J) \geq 6$. A primitive extension by one rank has the form

$$K = J + \mathbb{Z}(y + z), \qquad y \in J^*, \quad z \perp J, \quad s = \|z\|^2 > 0.$$

Choose y shortest in its class $a = y + J$. Then

$$d(K) = d(J)s, \tag{5}$$

$$K \text{ even integral} \iff s + \mu_J(a) \in 2\mathbb{Z}, \tag{6}$$

$$m(K) \geq 6 \iff m^2 s + \mu_J(ma) \geq 6 \quad (m \in \mathbb{Z} \setminus \{0\}). \tag{7}$$

The last identity follows by minimizing within each layer $J + m(y + z)$. It suffices to test positive m with $m^2 s < 6$. If the class has order h, the layer $m = h$ must also be respected: it gives $h^2 s \geq 6$.

The layer $m = 1$ yields the useful bound

$$d(K) \geq d(J)(6 - R_J). \tag{8}$$

If the extension continues a flag of shortest dual normals, then

$$s \geq \frac{3}{4m(J^*)}. \tag{9}$$

To prove this, lift a shortest vector $u \in J^*$ to K^*, choosing its coefficient along the perpendicular dual normal in $[-1/2, 1/2]$. Its squared norm is at most $m(J^*) + 1/(4s)$, whereas the shortest normal has squared norm $1/s$. This proves (9). For consecutive ranks 6, 7, and 8, it gives

$$d_8 \geq \frac{3d_7^2}{4d_6}. \tag{10}$$

3 Uniqueness in rank nine

Theorem 3.1. *Let L be a positive-definite even integral rank-nine lattice with $m(L) \geq 6$ and $d(L) = 21870$. Then $L \cong K_9$. Together with the earlier lower bound, this classifies every minimizer of $e_9(6)$: there is exactly one isometry class.*

3.1 Why the boundary required a new analysis

The earlier enumeration assumed $d_9 \leq 21868$. Equality at 21870 changes the upper windows, so transferring the old conclusion without additional checks would be incorrect. Using $\gamma_9 \leq 2^{8/7}$ gives

$$\left\lfloor 2^{8/7} 21870^{8/9} \right\rfloor = 15910.$$

This is certified by the integer comparison

$$15910^{63} \leq 2^{72} 21870^{56} < 15911^{63}.$$

Since $d_8 \equiv 0, 1 \pmod 4$, the largest permitted value is **15909**, rather than 15908.

Rank	8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1
Raw bound	15910	9494	4648	1894	634	178	39	7
After congruences	15909	9494	4648	1894	633	178	39	6

New cases occur only at $d_6 = 4648$, $d_7 = 9494$, and $d_8 = 15909$. The value $d_8 = 6561$, previously excluded for a strict counterexample, must also be restored. Equality in the rank-eight Hermite theorem, with uniqueness of its Euclidean extremizer, then gives $L_8 \cong \sqrt{3}E_8$.

3.2 Excluding the three new window endpoints

The exact extension generator (5)–(7) was run on every earlier parent representative:

Target case	Parents	Result
Rank 6, determinant 4648	118	No extension
Rank 7, determinant 9494	138	No extension
Rank 8, determinant 15909	6	No extension

Completeness of the second parent list follows from emptiness of the first new case. For the third list, (10) was reapplied to all 2235 earlier rank-seven records using the increased upper bound 15909. The same 96 records survive, identified with six representatives by exact unimodular matrices.

These 262 endpoint exclusions were additionally checked by an independent algorithm that does not call the earlier short-vector enumerator. Explicit dual vectors violating (9) certify 188 cases; the finite discriminant quadratic form excludes the remaining 74.

Here is the second method. For a parent Gram matrix G, set $d = \det G$ and $A = \operatorname{adj} G$. A class with pairing column p is encoded by

$$c = Ap \pmod{d}, \qquad Q(c) = p^{\mathsf{T}}Ap \pmod{2d}.$$

The value Q is well-defined: replacing p by $p + Gz$ changes the numerator by

$$2d\,p^{\mathsf{T}}z + d\,z^{\mathsf{T}}Gz \in 2d\mathbb{Z}.$$

All d classes are enumerated by adding columns of A, using the recurrence

$$Q(c + Ae_i) = Q(c) + 2c_i + A_{ii} \pmod{2d}.$$

An extension of determinant T with even last diagonal entry n requires

$$T = dn - p^{\mathsf{T}}Ap, \qquad Q(c) \equiv -T \pmod{2d}.$$

If this value does not occur, no extension exists, regardless of its minimum. A dual-vector exclusion only requires nonzero p satisfying

$$4T(p^{\mathsf{T}}Ap) < 3d^2.$$

This strictly contradicts the lifting inequality, whose proof works with this particular dual vector without requiring it to be shortest.

3.3 The three possible rank-eight parents

The earlier complete classification of the six branches, together with (8), leaves only

$$J_0 = \sqrt{3}E_8, \qquad J_1 = J_{14580}, \qquad J_2 = J_{15309a}.$$

For the remaining parents, the lower bounds are 32076, 36504, 39930, or 42282, or there is no permitted continuation of the flag.

To specify the two less familiar parents, let H be the matrix of $\sqrt{3}E_7$ in the earlier certificate, and write

$$\operatorname{border}(H, b, n) = \begin{pmatrix} H & b \\ b^{\mathsf{T}} & n \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then, in the fixed certificate basis,

$$J_1 = \operatorname{border}(H, (2, -3, -1, -3, -3, -3, -3)^{\mathsf{T}}, 6),$$

$$J_2 = \text{border}(H, (0, 2, 2, -1, -1, -1, -1)^{\mathsf{T}}, 6).$$

Here lattice symbols also denote their Gram matrices; H is the leading 7×7 block of the matrix G_8 displayed in Section 4. All changes of basis are supplied in the machine-readable package. The new proof uses the earlier complete classification as an explicitly identified input.

For each parent, fix $s = 21870/d(J)$ and recompute the full table of discriminant-class minima:

Parent	s	R_J	Classes	Admissible classes
$\sqrt{3}E_8$	$10/3$	$8/3$	6561	1920
J_{14580}	$3/2$	$9/2$	14580	1
J_{15309a}	$10/7$	$32/7$	15309	2

The complete enumerations examined respectively 26641, 190491, and 227617 dual vectors. Completeness of each class table is certified by the presence of $d(J)$ distinct classes in the exactly enumerated ball. Every vector outside that ball is longer than the representatives found. For J_2, the layer $m = 2$ is genuinely tested, since $4s = 40/7 < 6$.

3.4 Isometries of all 1923 presentations

Let $G_8 = 3C$ be the leading block of K_9, with C a Gram matrix of E_8. The reflections in the eight basis roots,

$$R_i = I - e_i(\text{row } i \text{ of } C),$$

are integral, have determinant -1, and preserve C. An orbit traversal from one admissible class produces exactly 1920 distinct classes, hence every admissible class for J_0. The orbit tree is retained.

A parent isometry sends the glue vector to the same class as the representative chosen for the next extension. The difference of representatives lies in J_0; adding it to the last basis vector is a unimodular change of basis. Thus all 1920 extensions are isometric. An independent verifier explicitly constructed and multiplied 1919 such block matrices, one for each edge of the tree. No claim that the selected reflections generate the full automorphism group is needed.

The other three extensions have pairing columns

$$\begin{aligned} J_1 &: \quad (-2, 0, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0, -3)^{\mathsf{T}}, \\ J_2 &: \quad (3, -2, -2, -2, -2, -2, -2, -3)^{\mathsf{T}}, \\ J_2 &: \quad (0, -3, -3, 0, 0, 0, 0, -3)^{\mathsf{T}}, \end{aligned}$$

and last diagonal entry 6. For each, an integer matrix U is supplied with

$$\det U = \pm 1, \qquad U^{\mathsf{T}} K_9 U = G.$$

Two exact procedures checked these identities. They give one isometry class, completing the proof of Theorem 3.1, relative to the original classification in lower ranks.

4 Rank ten with a $\sqrt{3}E_8$ sublattice

4.1 Fixed matrices

For independent use, we display the common block of the three principal examples:

$$G_8 = \begin{pmatrix} 6 & -3 & -3 & -3 & -3 & -3 & -3 & 3 \\ -3 & 6 & 3 & 3 & 3 & 3 & 3 & 0 \\ -3 & 3 & 6 & 0 & 3 & 0 & 0 & -3 \\ -3 & 3 & 0 & 6 & 3 & 3 & 3 & 0 \\ -3 & 3 & 3 & 3 & 6 & 3 & 3 & -3 \\ -3 & 3 & 0 & 3 & 3 & 6 & 3 & 0 \\ -3 & 3 & 0 & 3 & 3 & 3 & 6 & 0 \\ 3 & 0 & -3 & 0 & -3 & 0 & 0 & 6 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad C = G_8/3.$$

Set

$$p = (-2, 1, 3, -1, 1, 0, 1, -1)^{\mathsf{T}}, \qquad q = (1, -1, 1, 0, -1, -2, -2, 1)^{\mathsf{T}}.$$

Then

$$K_9 = \begin{pmatrix} G_8 & p \\ p^{\mathsf{T}} & 6 \end{pmatrix}, \quad K_{10} = \begin{pmatrix} G_8 & p & q \\ p^{\mathsf{T}} & 6 & 2 \\ q^{\mathsf{T}} & 2 & 6 \end{pmatrix}, \quad K_{10}^{\mathrm{alt}} = \begin{pmatrix} G_8 & p & -p \\ p^{\mathsf{T}} & 6 & -1 \\ -p^{\mathsf{T}} & -1 & 6 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{11}$$

The matrix C is even, positive definite, and unimodular. Its leading principal minors are $2, 3, 4, 4, 4, 3, 2, 1$. Consequently it defines E_8.

4.2 Classes in $E_8/3E_8$

For $J = \sqrt{3}E_8$, a class in J^*/J can be encoded by $u \in E_8/3E_8$; its minimum is one third of the least E_8 norm in that residue class. Complete enumeration through norm 8 gives:

Minimum E_8 norm	0	2	4	6	8
Classes	1	240	2160	2240	1920

The sum is $3^8 = 6561$. The full vector shells at these norms contain $1, 240, 2160, 6720, 17520$ vectors. Therefore

$$R_{\sqrt{3}E_8} = 8/3. \tag{12}$$

We call a class with minimum E_8 norm 8 deep; this is simply a name for the finite set of 1920 such classes.

Theorem 4.1. *Let L be an even integral rank-ten lattice with $m(L) \geq 6$ containing $J \cong \sqrt{3}E_8$. Then $d(L) \geq 54675$. Equality is attained by exactly two isometry classes: K_{10} and K_{10}^{alt} in (11).*

Proof of the lower bound. First, J is automatically primitive. Its saturation $\overline{J} = L \cap \operatorname{span}_{\mathbb{R}} J$ lies in J^*. A nonzero class of $\overline{J}/J$ would, after subtraction of a vector in J, yield a nonzero vector of norm at most $8/3$, contradicting $m(L) \geq 6$.

The projection P onto the two-dimensional orthogonal complement is a lattice. For nonzero $z \in P$, choose a lift $y + z \in L$. Integrality gives $y \in J^*$; subtracting a vector of J makes $\|y\|^2 \leq 8/3$. Hence

$$6 \leq \|y\|^2 + \|z\|^2 \leq 8/3 + \|z\|^2, \qquad m(P) \geq 10/3.$$

Every two-dimensional lattice satisfies

$$d(P) \geq \frac{3}{4} m(P)^2.$$

To see this, choose a shortest primitive vector z_1, extend it to a basis, and reduce z_2 so that $|(z_1, z_2)| \le \|z_1\|^2/2$. With $a = \|z_1\|^2$ and $b = \|z_2\|^2 \ge a$, its determinant is at least $ab - a^2/4 \ge 3a^2/4$. Thus

$$d(L) = 6561 d(P) \ge 6561 \cdot \frac{3}{4}\left(\frac{10}{3}\right)^2 = 54675.$$

□

4.3 Complete classification of equality

Equality forces, after changing a basis sign if necessary, the projected Gram matrix

$$S = \begin{pmatrix} 10/3 & 5/3 \\ 5/3 & 10/3 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{13}$$

Its minimal directions are $\pm z_1$, $\pm z_2$, and $\pm(z_1 - z_2)$. Let $a, b \in E_8/3E_8$ be the classes of the lifts. Minimum 6 requires a, b, and $a - b$ all to be deep.

Conversely, every such pair gives an admissible lattice. If u, v are norm-eight representatives, its Gram matrix is

$$\begin{pmatrix} 3C & Cu & Cv \\ u^{\mathsf{T}}C & 6 & (u^{\mathsf{T}}Cv + 5)/3 \\ v^{\mathsf{T}}C & (u^{\mathsf{T}}Cv + 5)/3 & 6 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{14}$$

The congruence $\|u - v\|_C^2 \equiv 8 \pmod 6$ gives $u^{\mathsf{T}}Cv \equiv 1 \pmod 3$, so the matrix is integral and even. The six minimal projected vectors give full minimum 6; every other nonzero projected vector has norm at least 10. Inside J, the minimum is 6. Therefore (14) has minimum 6 and determinant 54675.

Changing representatives by $3E_8$ adds vectors of J to the lifts, hence is an integral change of basis. An E_8 isometry also induces an isometry of the extension. Thus an upper bound on the number of classes follows from the orbits of admissible pairs under any explicitly constructed subgroup of automorphisms.

All 240 roots of E_8 are enumerated; identifying opposite roots gives 120 reflections. Their integrality, determinant -1, and preservation of C are checked exactly. They act transitively on the 1920 deep classes. Fix

$$a = w \pmod 3, \qquad w = C^{-1}p = (-1, -1, 2, -1, 0, 0, 1, 1)^{\mathsf{T}}.$$

There are exactly 561 deep classes b for which $a - b$ is deep. Of the 120 reflections, 36 fix a. Their generated subgroup splits the 561 classes into orbits of sizes

$$560 + 1;$$

the singleton is $b = -a$, and the large orbit contains the original K_{10}. Hence there are at most two full-lattice types. There is no need to prove that these 36 reflections generate the whole stabilizer.

Both types exist by (11), and they are not isometric:

$$\operatorname{rank}_{\mathbb{F}_3} K_{10} = 4, \qquad \operatorname{rank}_{\mathbb{F}_3} K_{10}^{\mathrm{alt}} = 3.$$

An integral isometry induces an invertible change of basis modulo 3 and preserves rank. This distinguishes the abstract lattices independently of their chosen E_8 embeddings and completes the equality classification.

4.4 Discriminant groups and vector shells

Both types have $d = 54675 = 3^7 \cdot 5^2$ and rank 8 modulo 5. Their ranks modulo 3 and the total 3-adic valuation yield, respectively, the valuation lists $(1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 2)$ and $(1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1)$. Consequently

$$A_{K_{10}} \cong (\mathbb{Z}/3\mathbb{Z})^4 \oplus \mathbb{Z}/15\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}/45\mathbb{Z},$$

$$A_{K_{10}^{\mathrm{alt}}} \cong (\mathbb{Z}/3\mathbb{Z})^5 \oplus (\mathbb{Z}/15\mathbb{Z})^2.$$

The exact numbers of oriented vectors at small norms are:

Lattice	Norm 6	Norm 8	Norm 10
K_{10}	294	216	756
K_{10}^{alt}	294	216	762

Agreement of the first two shells alone would not imply isometry; the ranks modulo 3 provide a shorter certificate of nonisometry.

An additional description of the alternative is that K_{10}^{alt} is an even overlattice of index 3 of $\sqrt{3}E_8 \perp \sqrt{5}A_2$. In the coordinates of (11), the two vectors orthogonal to E_8, $(0,\dots,0,1,1)$ and $(-w,1,-2)$, have Gram matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} 10 & -5 \\ -5 & 10 \end{pmatrix}.$$

The direct sum has determinant $6561 \cdot 75$; division by the squared index 9 gives 54675. The nonzero glue classes have minima $8/3$ and $10/3$, summing to 6.

5 A rank-nine gap and a preliminary rank-ten bound

The bounds in this section are retained as intermediate results with different dependency sets. The sharp current statements are Theorems 6.1 and 6.2, together with Corollary 6.5. In particular, 31595 is no longer the best established lower bound.

Proposition 5.1. *Using the public theorem $\gamma_9 = 2$, every even integral rank-nine lattice with $m(L) \geq 6$ and $d(L) \leq 24450$ is isometric to K_9. In particular, $L \ncong K_9$ implies $d(L) \geq 24452$.*

Proof. The earlier lower bound gives $D = d(L) \geq 21870$. For a shortest-dual section J, (3) and $\gamma_9 = 2$ give $d(J) \leq 2D^{8/9}$. The exact comparison

$$2^9 \cdot 24450^8 < 15912^9$$

implies $d(J) < 15912$. Since rank eight allows only residues $0, 1 \pmod 4$, this gives $d(J) \leq 15909$. This is precisely the verified expanded window of Section 3; no new classification outside that window is being assumed.

Every other branch has a lower bound above 24450. The remaining parents are J_0, J_1, J_2. With a shortest glue-class representative, the last diagonal $n = s + \mu_J(a)$ is an even integer at least 6. For each of the three parents,

$$d(J)(8 - R_J) > 24450,$$

so $n = 6$. Complete enumeration of all classes with

$$s = 6 - \mu_J(a), \qquad D = d(J)s$$

and verification of (7) throughout $21870 \leq D \leq 24450$ gives only $D = 21870$: exactly the earlier $1920 + 1 + 2$ classes. Every one is isometric to K_9. As a rank-nine determinant is even, the next value not excluded outside this class is 24452. □

The proposition does not assert that determinant 24452 is attained. It establishes an excluded interval, rather than the exact second value in the determinant spectrum.

Theorem 5.2. *With $\gamma_9 = 2$, the original rank-nine certificate, and the new results of Sections 3–5,*

$$\boxed{31595 \leq e_{10}(6) \leq 54675}.$$

Proof. The upper bound follows from both matrices in (11). If $D = d(L) \geq 54675$, the lower bound is immediate. Otherwise, Theorem 4.1 excludes every copy of $\sqrt{3}E_8$ in L.

A shortest-dual rank-nine section J is therefore not isometric to K_9, because K_9 contains $\sqrt{3}E_8$. Proposition 5.1 gives $d(J) \geq 24452$. The theorem $\gamma_9 = 2$ and Mordell's inequality give $\gamma_{10} \leq 2^{9/8}$. Consequently,

$$24452 \leq d(J) = Dm(L^*) \leq 2^{9/8} D^{9/10},$$

and hence

$$D \geq 24452^{10/9}/2^{5/4} = 31594.9287\ldots.$$

The rounding is checked without floating-point arithmetic: the comparison

$$2^{45} D^{36} \geq 24452^{40}$$

first holds at the integer $D = 31595$. This value also satisfies the required congruence $D \equiv 0, 3 \pmod 4$. □

Smaller sets of external inputs yield weaker but useful control bounds. The classical constants through rank eight and the original value of $e_9(6)$ alone give $e_{10}(6) \geq 24663$. Neumaier's theorem $\gamma_{10} < 16/7$ [4] gives 26495. Using $\gamma_9 = 2$ without the new gap gives 27911. The value 31595 requires the full chain of new results stated above.

The next section strengthens this preliminary bound to an exact value. Its new complete chain does not use the original rank-nine lower bound or the previous gap certificate.

6 The global determinant bound in rank ten

Theorem 6.1. *Every positive-definite even integral lattice of rank ten with minimum squared norm at least 6 has determinant at least 54675. Consequently,*

$$\boxed{e_{10}(6) = 54675}.$$

This is a computer-assisted result with the inputs specified explicitly below. The examples K_{10} and K_{10}^{alt} attain the bound. The strict search first proves the minimum; the additional equality-window computation in Theorem 6.2 then proves that these are all minimizers.

6.1 Why a finite enlarged window suffices

Suppose that a counterexample L_{10} exists with determinant $D < 54675$. Evenness in rank ten gives $D \equiv 0, 3 \pmod 4$, so $D \leq 54672$. Theorem 4.1 excludes any copy of $\sqrt{3}E_8$ in L_{10}. Neither the earlier lower bound for $e_9(6)$ nor Proposition 5.1 is used in what follows.

The public theorem $\gamma_9 = 2$ and Mordell's inequality give $\gamma_{10} \leq 2^{9/8}$. Successive application of (3), together with the exact classical constants through rank eight and determinant congruences, gives:

Rank	Lower bound	Upper bound
1	6	6
2	27	44
3	108	210
4	324	789
5	972	2492
6	2187	6459
7	4374	13938
8	6564	24673
9	19684	40054
10	—	54672

All rounding is checked using integer powers, without floating-point arithmetic. For example, the top transition uses the comparison

$$d_9^{40} \le 2^{45} D^{36},$$

and the next uses $d_8^9 \le 2^9 d_9^8$. The integer upper bounds obtained from the real-valued bounds in ranks eight and four are 24675 and 790; the congruence modulo 4 reduces them to 24673 and 789.

We explain the lower endpoints without invoking the earlier computations. In ranks one through eight, the Hermite inequality gives, respectively,

$$6,\ 27,\ 108,\ 324,\ 972,\ 2187,\ 4374,\ 6561.$$

Equality in rank eight is possible only for $\sqrt{3}E_8$, which has already been excluded analytically. The next permitted determinant is 6564. In rank nine, the inequality $\gamma_9 \le 2$ gives $d_9 \ge 3^9 = 19683$; evenness of the determinant raises the bound to 19684. No lower endpoint is needed in rank ten. In particular, the unique initial object in the flag is $[6]$; this follows from the window and is not an assumption that the lattice is generated by its minimal vectors.

The full rank-nine interval is divided into $[19684, 24450]$ and $[24452, 40054]$. The only omitted integer between them is 24451, which is odd and therefore impossible in rank nine. The splitting point is not an input theorem about the determinant spectrum.

Any hypothetical counterexample has a primitive flag of shortest-dual sections lying entirely within these windows. To reconstruct the flag from the bottom up, it suffices to enumerate all one-step extensions using (5)–(7), with the additional requirement that the perpendicular dual normal be shortest.

6.2 An exact integer test for the dual normal

We describe the acceleration on which completeness of the search depends. Let a parent have Gram matrix G, determinant d, and adjugate matrix $A = \operatorname{adj} G$. Let the new vector be specified by its column of pairings p and its even diagonal entry n. The determinant of the child is

$$D = nd - p^{\mathsf{T}} A p, \qquad s = D/d.$$

The squared norm of the dual vector with coordinates (q, m) is

$$q^{\mathsf{T}} G^{-1} q + \frac{(m - p^{\mathsf{T}} G^{-1} q)^2}{s}.$$

If $q = 0$, a nonzero vector is no shorter than the perpendicular normal of squared norm $1/s$. If $q \neq 0$, minimizing over integer m gives the distance to the nearest integer. Thus the normal is shortest if and only if the exact integer condition

$$D(q^{\mathsf{T}} A q) + \operatorname{dist}(p^{\mathsf{T}} A q, d\mathbb{Z})^2 \ge d^2 \tag{15}$$

holds for every nonzero q with $D(q^{\mathsf{T}}Aq) < d^2$. All other q are automatically safe.

If $D \geq D_{\min}$, a single complete list of parent dual vectors up to squared norm $d/D_{\min}$ contains all required q. It is constructed using the existing exact rational enumerator; one representative of each pair $\pm q$ suffices, since condition (15) is invariant under changing the sign.

The class with pairing column p is encoded by Ap mod d. If M_a is the integer numerator of its exact minimum, then the layer condition becomes

$$m^2 D + M_{ma} \geq 6d \qquad (m > 0,\ m^2 D < 6d). \tag{16}$$

This check includes nonzero layers of the zero class. The complete minimum tables cover exactly d classes; the diagonal entry n and the congruences for D are checked exactly. The acceleration changes the form of the computation, but not the set of admissible extensions.

Seeing one vector in each class would not by itself establish completeness of the minimum table. The entire dual ball is enumerated through a rational bound at which all d classes have been covered; the least norm seen in each class is then its global minimum. Ball completeness follows from recursion using an exact LDL^{T} decomposition: all previously separated square terms are nonnegative, and the remaining budget gives the complete integer interval for the next coordinate. Its endpoints are obtained with rational arithmetic and integer square roots, with no inward floating-point rounding. For each class, *every* even n in the determinant window is considered; no condition $n = 6$ is imposed here.

For every parent used, the equality

$$m(J^*) = \frac{\det(\text{leading block of the parent})}{\det(\text{parent})}$$

is checked separately. Consequently, the inequality for the next step,

$$d_{r+1} \geq \frac{3d_r^2}{4d_{r-1}}, \tag{17}$$

is applied to a verified shortest-dual flag, rather than to an arbitrary section chosen from a basis.

6.3 Complete candidate coverage and the final exclusion

The following exact results were obtained in the enlarged window. The "Retained" column counts records not excluded by the necessary bound (17) for the next rank. The representatives are used to cover these records, not to assert a complete classification of all lattices of the given rank.

Rank	All records	Excluded from continuation	Retained	Representatives
2	9	0	9	6
3	102	0	102	31
4	729	0	729	161
5	6934	0	6934	925
6	28284	0	28284	3752
7	56269	52208	4061	224
8	19481	18110	1371	47
9, lower interval	0	0	0	0
9, upper interval	3819	3819	0	0

In rank seven, all 3752 rank-six parents are covered. Only 500 of them permit continuation after the preliminary necessary bound; the others are excluded before the expensive enumeration. In rank eight, all 224 retained representatives are processed, as are all 47 parents for each rank-nine interval. No parent in a required input list is replaced by a selected trial computation.

During reduction to representatives, every retained record is accompanied by an explicit unimodular isometry; all such matrices have been checked by exact multiplication. Therefore, even without assuming that the isometry-recognition algorithm is flawless, merging classes cannot remove a mathematically new possibility without a certified transport to a retained representative. Completeness of the initial list is established separately by the extension generator.

An isometry need not preserve the earlier marked subflag: continuation depends on the parent lattice itself and all its discriminant classes. Each representative is chosen from the actual generated matrices, so it has a valid shortest-dual flag of its own. Any next extension transports across the isometry to that representative. The exclusion bound depends on the intrinsic invariant $m(J^*)$, rather than on an arbitrary marking; a different choice of the preceding flag cannot restore an excluded case.

For the upper rank-nine interval, the bound (17) exceeds the permitted upper limit 54672 for all 3819 records. The smallest of these necessary bounds is

$$\frac{12966723}{212} = 61163.7877\ldots > 54672.$$

Thus none of these records can be the penultimate member of the flag of a hypothetical counterexample. The lower interval produced no records; we additionally give a short independent certificate for it.

For 45 of the 47 rank-eight parents, an explicit dual vector gives, through (9), a necessary lower bound on the next determinant exceeding 24450. For this purpose, the chosen vector need not even be proved shortest. The two remaining parents have determinants 14641 and 13689. Independent exact enumeration of dual vectors up to squared norm 4 covers all 14641 and 13689 discriminant classes, respectively. Hence both have $R_J \le 4$. By (7), the layer $m = 1$ requires $s \ge 6 - R_J \ge 2$, so the determinant of an extension is at least 29282 or 27378, respectively. Both numbers exceed 24450. The entire lower interval is therefore excluded.

Thus no branch of the full rank-nine interval continues to a rank-ten counterexample. Direct enumeration of rank-ten matrices is unnecessary: a necessary condition for continuation fails at an earlier stage.

The matrices K_{10} and K_{10}^{alt} have minimum 6 and determinant 54675, so the lower bound is attained. This completes the proof of Theorem 6.1.

For the singleton antipode construction in dimension 38 at the guaranteed radius $\sqrt{6}/2$, this gives

$$\delta_{38} \le \frac{(3/2)^{19}}{\sqrt{54675}}.$$

The displayed embedding of K_{10} attains this value. Consequently, replacing the rank-ten section by another of minimum at least 6 cannot improve this singleton construction. This is not an upper bound for all packings in dimension 38, nor does it resolve the general problem of clusters with more than one point.

6.4 Dependencies and reproducibility of the strict bound

The complete argument uses the public result $\gamma_9 \le 2$, the classical Hermite constants through rank eight and uniqueness of Hermite equality in rank eight, Mordell's inequality, the discriminant-class minima of $\sqrt{3}E_8$, the rank-ten subclass Theorem 4.1 based on the planar Hermite bound, and the new complete flag enumeration. *The old rank-nine lower-bound certificate and the old gap proof are not dependencies of this argument.* The public classification of perfect forms underlying $\gamma_9 = 2$ is not reproduced by this package.

The optimized generator uses the existing rational vector enumerator. Independent verification of the full chain covers the exact windows, every parent list, the exclusions, and the maps to representatives; the dual minima of 8966 matrices were checked again using a separate enumerator. The lower interval was additionally excluded by a program that imports neither the original extension generator nor its vector enumerator. These checks constitute an internal audit, not external refereeing.

In addition, a complete generation replay reproduced all 1897 required parent lists and 115627 raw matrices from scratch; every result matched the stored records. The replay completed with status

`PASS_FULL_EXACT_REPLAY`. It uses the audited generators and therefore does not replace an independent implementation of the entire program.

The principal files, relative to `certificates/`, are `research_20261007/rank10/fast_extension_proof.txt`, `research_20261007/rank10/verify_global_rank10_certificate.py`, `research_20261007/independent_review/check_rank10_global_chain.py`, `research_20261007/independent_review/check_global_rank10_windows.py`, and `research_20261007/independent_review/check_rank9_low_by_radius.py`.

6.5 Completion of the global equality classification

The strict computation proves the minimum but, by itself, does not settle equality. Passing from $D \le 54672$ to $D = 54675$ changes several intermediate determinant windows and can restore branches previously removed by a lifting inequality. The following additional argument checks both effects.

Theorem 6.2. *Let L be a positive-definite even integral lattice of rank ten with $m(L) \ge 6$ and $d(L) = 54675$. Then L contains a sublattice isometric to $\sqrt{3}E_8$ and*

$$L \cong K_{10} \quad \text{or} \quad L \cong K_{10}^{\mathrm{alt}}.$$

These two lattices are not isometric. Thus $e_{10}(6) = 54675$ has exactly two global equality classes. The external and computational assumptions are those stated for Theorem 6.1, supplemented by the complete equality-boundary certificates described below.

Proof. Suppose that L contains no $\sqrt{3}E_8$. Choose the successive primitive shortest-dual sections as in (2). The upper windows at equality, rounded using exact integer powers and determinant congruences, are as follows. All lower bounds remain the ones in the strict search.

Rank	Strict upper bound	Equality upper bound	New determinant
1	6	6	—
2	44	44	—
3	210	210	—
4	789	789	—
5	2492	2492	—
6	6459	6460	6460
7	13938	13940	13940
8	24673	24676	24676
9	40054	40056	40056
10	54672	54675	54675

In particular, the rank-eight lower bound is still 6564: determinant 6561 would force $\sqrt{3}E_8$, contrary to the assumption. The ranks through five are unchanged.

Restoring previously excluded branches. A continuation prune has the form

$$3d_r^2 > 4d_{r-1}U_{r+1}.$$

Increasing U_{r+1} may invalidate this inequality even if d_r is in its old interval. Therefore it is not enough to examine new endpoint determinants from the old retained lists. Every old prune was checked again at the enlarged upper bounds:

Family	Old prunes	Restored records
Whole searches from rank-six parents	3252	0
Raw rank-seven continuation records	52208	4
Raw rank-eight continuation records	18110	0
Raw rank-nine continuation records	3819	0

The four restored rank-seven matrices have $d_6 = 4131$ and $d_7 = 11658$. Their next determinant satisfies

$$d_8 \geq \frac{3 \cdot 11658^2}{4 \cdot 4131} = \frac{3775249}{153}, \qquad 24673 < \frac{3775249}{153} < 24676. \tag{18}$$

Within the enlarged window, rank-eight determinant congruences thus force $d_8 = 24676$. These four raw matrices are all retained for the additional check; no new isometry merging is required.

An independent necessary-condition certificate. We give a second, simpler computation for the equality boundary. It imports neither the original extension generator nor its vector enumerator, and it does not need the minima of the discriminant classes. Let G be a parent Gram matrix of rank r, $d = \det G$, and $A = \operatorname{adj} G$. An integral one-vector extension with even last diagonal n and pairing column p has target determinant

$$T = nd - p^{\mathsf{T}} A p.$$

Its class can be encoded by

$$c = Ap \pmod{d}, \qquad Q(c) = p^{\mathsf{T}} A p \pmod{2d}.$$

The value Q is well-defined: replacing p by $p + Gz$ changes the quadratic expression by $2d\, z^{\mathsf{T}} p + d\, z^{\mathsf{T}} G z$, a multiple of $2d$ because G is even. The kernel of $p \mapsto Ap \pmod{d}$ is $G\mathbb{Z}^r$; hence exactly d classes occur.

The classes and values are generated from $c = 0$, $Q(0) = 0$ by adding the columns Ae_j and using the exact recurrence

$$Q(c + Ae_j) = Q(c) + 2c_j + A_{jj} \pmod{2d}. \tag{19}$$

The program checks consistency on every repeated class and verifies that precisely d classes have been reached. Evenness of n requires

$$Q(c) \equiv -T \pmod{2d}. \tag{20}$$

A preliminary content test is also valid: if

$$g = \gcd\big(2d,\ (A_{ii})_i,\ (2A_{ij})_{i<j}\big)$$

does not divide T, no such class can exist.

For each class satisfying (20), the new perpendicular normal must be shortest in the dual lattice. By (15), a necessary condition is

$$T(q^{\mathsf{T}} A q) + \operatorname{dist}(q^{\mathsf{T}} c, d\mathbb{Z})^2 \geq d^2 \tag{21}$$

for every nonzero integral q with $T(q^{\mathsf{T}} A q) < d^2$. The independent exact rational enumerator lists all required q inside $q^{\mathsf{T}} G^{-1} q \leq d/T$. A single violating q excludes the class. If any classes survive, a child that can continue to the next member of the full shortest-dual flag must satisfy the next lifting inequality

$$3T^2 \leq 4d\, U_{r+2}. \tag{22}$$

All classes surviving the preceding tests in this computation violate (22). Ignoring the full minimum test for a child is safe: the tests used here are necessary conditions, and they already eliminate every branch.

The complete additional coverage consists of 4952 parent–target pairs:

Parent source	Number	Target	Surviving classes	Continuing
Old rank-five representatives	925	6460	58	0
Old rank-six representatives	3752	13940	20	0
Old rank-seven representatives	224	24676	0	0
Restored rank-seven raw records	4	24676	0	0
Old rank-eight representatives	47	40056	0	0

Here "surviving classes" counts the classes remaining after the determinant congruence and shortest-normal tests, before the next lifting inequality. These are computational records, not numbers of isometry types. The 58 classes arise from four parent matrices, and the 20 classes from six parent matrices. Every one fails the next lifting inequality. All four restored rank-seven forms are excluded by nonrepresentation of the target residue in their finite quadratic modules.

The decisive next-step comparisons can be seen directly. The parent determinants for the 58 rank-six classes are $1934, 1830, 1672, 1600$, with respective multiplicities $2, 4, 4, 48$. For the 20 rank-seven classes they are $4428, 4443, 4268, 4379, 4355, 4920$, with respective multiplicities $2, 4, 4, 4, 4, 2$. Even the largest parent determinant in each family gives

$$3 \cdot 6460^2 = 125194800 > 4 \cdot 1934 \cdot 13940 = 107839840,$$
$$3 \cdot 13940^2 = 582970800 > 4 \cdot 4920 \cdot 24676 = 485623680.$$

Thus all 78 remaining classes are explicitly ruled out from a full flag.

For an additional check on exhaustive coverage, the 4952 pairs split into mutually exclusive exclusion categories: 3960 are removed by a known parent dual vector, 493 by the content test, 420 by finite-module nonrepresentation, 69 by explicit shorter dual vectors for every compatible class, and 10 by the next lifting inequality for the remaining classes. The sum is exactly 4952.

Why this covers the whole equality window. The lower-rank prefix through rank five is unchanged. Every newly permitted rank-six form would arise at determinant 6460 from one of the 925 old parents, but none can continue to rank seven. Consequently, at rank seven the only new possibilities are the endpoint 13940 over the old rank-six parents and the four restored old records. The endpoint cases cannot continue. At rank eight, the endpoint 24676 is checked over all 224 old representatives and all four restored records, with no surviving child. There is therefore no new rank-eight parent to extend over the rest of the rank-nine interval. The endpoint 40056 over all 47 old rank-eight representatives is likewise excluded. The old lower rank-nine interval remains empty, and every old upper-interval record still satisfies

$$d_{10} \geq \frac{12966723}{212} > 54675.$$

Thus all old and newly admitted flags are excluded. The argument uses the previously certified transports to representatives and the complete check of restored prunes; it does not assume that a hypothetical minimizer contains K_9 or has a basis consisting of minimal vectors.

We have reached a contradiction to the existence of an equality lattice containing no $\sqrt{3}E_8$. Hence every minimizer contains this sublattice. Theorem 4.1 supplies exactly the two possibilities K_{10} and K_{10}^{alt}; their Gram ranks modulo 3 are respectively 4 and 3, so they remain nonisometric as abstract integral lattices. This proves the theorem. □

The independent equality checks are in `research_20261008/independent_review/check_equality_windows_and_recovered_prunes.py` and `research_20261008/independent_review/check_boundaries_by_quadratic_module.py`. Their certificate statuses are `PASS` and `ALL_EXCLUDED`; the second covers all 4952 pairs. These files reuse the earlier independently implemented rational matrix and vector arithmetic, not the original extension kernel. The complete earlier strict-search certificate remains a dependency. The separate public proof of $\gamma_9 \leq 2$ is still an external input. None of these internal checks constitutes external refereeing.

As corroboration by the original extension method, a fresh generation completed all 5010 parent jobs: 4952 endpoint pairs and 58 attempted continuations from the new rank-six matrices. Of these jobs, 4018 were immediately excluded by parent lifting bounds and 992 enumerated their full discriminant-class tables. Exactly 58 rank-six and 20 rank-seven raw matrices were generated. None survives into a complete flag, and the rank-eight and rank-nine additions are empty. A separate independent audit checks every job configuration and parent linkage, independently verifies the 78 raw matrices and their primal and dual minima, and matches their exact class fingerprints to the finite-module certificate. This is a completed fresh generation and a completed independent audit; a second full generation replay is available as an option and is not claimed to have been run again.

The main additional verifier is `research_20261008/rank10_equality/verify_equality_certificate.py`; its saved status is `PASS_STATIC_EQUALITY_CERTIFICATE`, with marker `GLOBAL_RANK10_EQUALITY_TWO_TYPES_PASS`. The independent job audit is `research_20261008/independent_review/check_delta_chain_independent.py`. Once the base certificate has been checked, the main verifier accepts `--skip-base`; the optional `--replay` flag regenerates the additional jobs. A static certificate check and an exhaustive regeneration are different operations, and their statuses are recorded separately.

6.6 Intrinsic structure of every rank-ten minimizer

Proposition 6.3 (Intrinsic structure of the rank-ten equality lattices)**.** *Let K be an even integral rank-ten lattice with $m(K) \geq 6$ and $d(K) = 54675$. Then:*

1. *$m(K^*) = 2/5$, and K^* has exactly six minimal vectors. Their span is a two-dimensional plane V and their generated lattice is isometric to $A_2/\sqrt{5}$.*
2. *K has exactly one sublattice isometric to $\sqrt{3}E_8$. It is intrinsically determined by*

$$J = K \cap V^{\perp}.$$

3. *K has exactly three primitive rank-nine sublattices of determinant 21870. All three contain J and are isometric to K_9.*

Theorem 6.2 supplies a copy of $\sqrt{3}E_8$ in every such K.

Proof. Choose a copy $J \cong \sqrt{3}E_8$ in K. The glue-radius bound $8/3 < 6$ forces J to be primitive. Equality in the binary determinant bound gives the projected lattice P perpendicular to J the Gram matrix

$$\frac{5}{3}\begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Consequently the perpendicular dual fiber

$$T = K^* \cap \operatorname{span}(J)^{\perp}$$

has Gram matrix

$$\frac{1}{5}\begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 \\ -1 & 2 \end{pmatrix};$$

it has exactly six vectors of squared norm $2/5$, and they generate T. The projection of any vector of K^* onto $\operatorname{span}(J)$ belongs to J^*. Every nonzero vector of $J^* \cong E_8/\sqrt{3}$ has squared norm at least $2/3$. Therefore every vector of K^* of squared norm at most $2/5$ belongs to T. This proves the first assertion and defines V without any reference to the chosen copy of J.

Apply the same argument to any other copy J' of $\sqrt{3}E_8$. Its perpendicular dual fiber must contain the same six minimal vectors, which span V. Hence $\operatorname{span}(J') = V^{\perp}$. Automatic primitivity gives $J' = K \cap V^{\perp} = J$.

Every primitive rank-nine sublattice H of K is the kernel in K of a primitive vector $y \in K^*$, unique up to sign:

$$H = \{x \in K : \langle x, y\rangle = 0\}.$$

Here primitivity of y means that $x \mapsto \langle x, y\rangle$ maps K onto $\mathbb{Z}$. A lift of 1 has perpendicular height $1/\|y\|$, so the covolume identity gives

$$\det H = (\det K)\|y\|^2.$$

Thus $\det H = 21870$ if and only if $\|y\|^2 = 2/5$. All six minimal dual vectors are primitive, and distinct pairs $\{y, -y\}$ give distinct kernels. There are exactly three kernels. Since $y \in V$, they all contain J. Their projected rank-one lattice perpendicular to J has squared step $21870/6561 = 10/3$. Its glue class must therefore be a deepest J^*/J class, of minimum $8/3$. Transitivity on the 1920 deepest classes identifies every such rank-nine extension with K_9. □

Every copy of K_9 in K is automatically primitive: a proper saturation would be an even integral rank-nine lattice of minimum at least 6 and determinant smaller than $e_9(6) = 21870$. Thus the count of three primitive sublattices is also the count of all sublattices isometric to K_9.

In the displayed bases, the six primitive dual pairing columns are

$$(0, \dots, 0, \pm 1, 0), \quad (0, \dots, 0, 0, \pm 1), \quad (0, \dots, 0, \pm 1, \pm 1),$$

where the signs in the last pair agree. The three kernels therefore have integral bases obtained from the eight basis vectors of J by adjoining, respectively, e_{10}, e_9, and $e_9 - e_{10}$. The latter generator need not itself be shortest; changing it by a vector of J supplies a representative of squared norm six.

6.7 A new independent consequence for rank nine

Corollary 6.4. *The public bound $\gamma_9 \le 2$, together with the new flag enumeration and the class table of $\sqrt{3}E_8$, gives an alternative proof of*

$$e_9(6) = 21870, \qquad d(L) \le 24450 \Longrightarrow L \cong K_9.$$

It does not use the old rank-nine certificate.

Proof. Let L have rank nine, minimum at least 6, and $D \le 24450$. Its shortest-dual parent of rank eight has determinant at most 15909; its entire flag lies within the new, wider window. All necessary filters applied to this prefix remain valid, since the final determinant is at most 24450 and therefore at most 40054.

If the parent is not isometric to $\sqrt{3}E_8$, it belongs to the new list and is excluded by the lower interval. Hence the parent is $\sqrt{3}E_8$. Its class has minimum $\mu \in \{0, 2/3, 4/3, 2, 8/3\}$. After choosing a shortest representative, the adjoined vector has even squared norm $n \ge 6$, and

$$D = 6561(n - \mu).$$

For $n = 6$, the smallest value is 21870 and the next is 26244. For $n \ge 8$, we have $D \ge 34992$. Thus $D \le 24450$ allows only determinant 21870 and only one of the 1920 deep classes with $\mu = 8/3$. Their verified transitive orbit gives a single isometry type K_9. This example exists and has minimum 6, proving both assertions. □

Thus the dependencies are not circular: the new enumeration proves Theorem 6.1 directly and then, separately, yields Corollary 6.4. The earlier route to uniqueness retains a different set of assumptions and does not require the public constant $\gamma_9 = 2$ in its own equality case.

6.8 The first rank-nine determinants and the first case without $\sqrt{3}E_8$

Corollary 6.5. *Under the same assumptions, the set of determinants strictly below 32076 of even integral rank-nine lattices of minimum at least 6 is exactly*

$$\{21870,\ 26244,\ 30618\}.$$

At each of these three determinants there is exactly one isometry class. Thus the next determinant after K_9 is exactly 26244. The least determinant of a lattice of this rank and minimum containing no $\sqrt{3}E_8$ is exactly 32076.

Proof. The smallest determinant among all 3819 upper-interval records is 32076. For the rank-nine conclusion, we do not apply the last exclusion, which concerns rank ten: we use the complete list *before* that exclusion. For any $d_9 < 32076$, all necessary upper windows lie within the new prefix constructed for $d_9 \le 40054$. Hence the shortest-dual parent must be $\sqrt{3}E_8$.

As in the preceding proof, $D = 6561(n - \mu)$, where $n \ge 6$ is even and $\mu \in \{0, 2/3, 4/3, 2, 8/3\}$. For $n \ge 8$, we have $D \ge 34992$. For $n = 6$, exactly the three stated values are below 32076. All are attained: $s = 6 - \mu \ge 10/3$ gives first-layer minimum 6, while layers $|m| \ge 2$ have squared norms at least $4s > 6$.

The exact E_8 reflection computation is transitive on each of the three relevant class sets, of sizes 1920, 2240, and 2160. These integral isometries transport the one-vector extensions and prove uniqueness at each determinant. The respective counts of oriented minimal vectors are 258, 246, and 242.

In the basis of G_8 from Section 4, examples of determinants 26244 and 30618 are the matrices $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} G_8 & p \\ p^{\mathsf{T}} & 6 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ with the respective columns

$$p = (1, -1, 0, -1, -1, -3, 0, 0)^{\mathsf{T}}, \qquad p = (0, 1, -1, 1, 0, 1, 2, 2)^{\mathsf{T}}.$$

An example containing no $\sqrt{3}E_8$ has Gram matrix

$$G_{32076} = \begin{pmatrix} 6 & -3 & -3 & -3 & -3 & -3 & -3 & -3 & -3 \\ -3 & 6 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ -3 & 0 & 6 & 0 & 0 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ -3 & 0 & 0 & 6 & 3 & 0 & 3 & 3 & 2 \\ -3 & 0 & 0 & 3 & 6 & 0 & 3 & 3 & 2 \\ -3 & 0 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 6 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ -3 & 0 & 0 & 3 & 3 & 0 & 6 & 3 & 3 \\ -3 & 0 & 0 & 3 & 3 & 1 & 3 & 6 & 2 \\ -3 & 0 & 1 & 2 & 2 & 1 & 3 & 2 & 6 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Exact verification gives positive definiteness, determinant 32076, minimum 6, and 180 oriented minimal vectors. A copy of $\sqrt{3}E_8$ would be primitive and would give

$$D = 3^7(3n - p^{\mathsf{T}}C^{-1}p), \qquad C = G_8/3.$$

Since n is even and C^{-1} is an even integral Gram matrix, this determinant is divisible by $2 \cdot 3^7 = 4374$. But $32076 \equiv 1458 \pmod{4374}$, so the example contains no $\sqrt{3}E_8$. The lower bound has already been proved by prefix completeness. □

Exact examples and checks are stored in `research_20261007/rank10/rank9_low_spectrum.json` and `research_20261007/rank10/verify_rank9_low_spectrum.py`. Excluding smaller determinants uses the complete prefix certificate; checking a single matrix does not replace it. No uniqueness assertion is made at determinant 32076.

7 Cluster extensions: the general geometry

7.1 Comparing densities

Let K be a primitive rank-k section of an even unimodular rank-48 lattice of minimum 6. For a finite cluster $S \subset K^*$, put

$$s = |S|, \qquad \beta = \max_{u,v \in S} \|u - v\|^2 < 6.$$

The antipode construction guarantees sphere radius $\sqrt{6-\beta}/2$ in dimension $n = 48 - k$ and center density

$$\delta(S, K) = \frac{s(6-\beta)^{n/2}}{2^n \sqrt{d(K)}}. \tag{23}$$

If a particular ambient embedding has a larger actual minimum, its improved radius requires a separate analysis. All assertions in this report concern the radius guaranteed specifically by $6 - \beta$.

Relative to a singleton cluster over the same K, the factor is

$$R = s(1 - \beta/6)^{n/2}. \tag{24}$$

For $\beta < 6$, distinct points of S have distinct classes in K^*/K: otherwise their difference would be a nonzero vector of K of norm less than 6. Thus $s \le d(K)$.

7.2 Projection onto eight dimensions and its fibers

Let $J \cong \sqrt{3}E_8 \subset K$. The orthogonal projection of K^* onto $\mathrm{span}_{\mathbb{R}}\, J$ lies in J^*, by its integral pairings with J. Hence every positive squared distance between projected points belongs to $(2/3)\mathbb{Z}$.

Each nonempty projection fiber is a translate of the lattice

$$T = K^* \cap (\mathrm{span}_{\mathbb{R}}\, J)^{\perp}.$$

If the Gram matrix of K is written in blocks as $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} A & B \\ B^{\mathsf{T}} & D \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, then the Gram matrix of T is the inverse of the Schur complement $D - B^{\mathsf{T}}A^{-1}B$. For our examples,

$$K_9 :\ T = [3/10], \qquad K_{10}, K_{10}^{\mathrm{alt}} :\ T = \frac{1}{5}\begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 \\ -1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \cong A_2/\sqrt{5}. \tag{25}$$

Neither surjectivity of the projection nor its particular glue data is needed in the estimates that follow.

7.3 Bounding sets with few distances

An equidistant set in $\mathbb{R}^8$ has at most 9 points. A convenient general bound for a set $P \subset \mathbb{R}^8$ with r distinct positive squared distances is

$$|P| \le \binom{9+r}{r}. \tag{26}$$

For each $x \in P$, consider

$$f_x(y) = \prod_{i=1}^{r} (\|x - y\|^2 - d_i).$$

The evaluation matrix on P is diagonal with nonzero diagonal entries, so the polynomials f_x are linearly independent. The expansion $\|x - y\|^2 = \|y\|^2 - 2(x, y) + \|x\|^2$ places them in the sum of spaces

$$\sum_{j=0}^{r} \|y\|^{2j} \mathcal{P}_{\le r-j}(\mathbb{R}^8).$$

The sum of the dimensions is $\sum_{k=0}^{r}\binom{8+k}{k}=\binom{9+r}{r}$, proving (26). The bound is not optimal, but it suffices here.

For a projected cluster this yields bounds of 9 when $\beta<4/3$, 55 when $\beta<2$, 220 when $\beta<8/3$, 715 when $\beta<3$, and 24310 when $\beta<6$. The first uses the sharper equidistant-set bound.

8 No improvement throughout the rank-nine family

Theorem 8.1. *Let K be any even integral rank-nine lattice with $m(K)\ge 6$ containing $\sqrt{3}E_8$, and let $S\subset K^*$ be a finite cluster with $\beta<6$. Then*

$$\delta(S,K)\le\frac{6^{39/2}}{2^{39}\sqrt{21870}}.$$

Equality is possible only when $s=1$ and $d(K)=21870$. For every nontrivial cluster, the ratio to the right-hand side is at most

$$9(8/9)^{39/2}=0.9052495585\ldots<1.$$

The bound 0.90525 is not claimed to be sharp.

Proof. The embedded $J=\sqrt{3}E_8$ is automatically primitive, as in Section 4. Equation (8) gives $D=d(K)\ge 21870$. The one-dimensional fiber T has spacing

$$\tau=\sqrt{6561/D}\le\tau_0=\sqrt{3/10}.$$

Set $f(\beta)=(1-\beta/6)^{39/2}$. The ratio to the singleton packing over K_9 is

$$R=\sqrt{10/3}\,\tau s f(\beta). \tag{27}$$

Let M be the number of nonempty projection fibers, and let s_i be the number of points in the ith fiber. Their vertical span is at least

$$\ell_i=(s_i-1)\tau,\qquad \ell_i\le\sqrt{\beta}.$$

The largest vertical distance between two fibers is at least $(\ell_i+\ell_j)/2$. Thus, for different projected points p_i,p_j,

$$\beta\ge\|p_i-p_j\|^2+(\ell_i+\ell_j)^2/4. \tag{28}$$

One projected point. If $M=1$ and $s\ge 2$, then $\beta\ge(s-1)^2\tau^2$, giving

$$R\le\frac{s}{s-1}\sqrt{10\beta/3}\,f(\beta).$$

The maximum of $\sqrt{\beta}f(\beta)$ occurs at $\beta=3/20$. Therefore

$$R\le\sqrt{2}(39/40)^{39/2}<1.$$

For $s=1$, we have $\beta=0$ and $R=\sqrt{21870/D}\le 1$, with the stated equality case.

Several projected points, $\beta<4/3$. Necessarily $\beta\ge 2/3$, and $M\le 9$. If every fiber is a singleton, then

$$R\le 9f(2/3)=9(8/9)^{39/2}<1.$$

Otherwise, let $t\ge u$ be the two largest fiber cardinalities. Then $t\ge 2$, $u\ge 1$, and $s\le t+(M-1)u$, while (28) gives

$$\tau(t+u-2)\le 2\sqrt{\beta-2/3}.$$

Since

$$\frac{t+(M-1)u}{t+u-2}\le M+1$$

(after multiplication, the difference is $M(t-2)+2(u-1)\geq 0$), we obtain

$$R \leq 20\sqrt{(10/3)(\beta-2/3)}\, f(\beta).$$

The right-hand side is maximized at $\beta = 4/5$, with value

$$\frac{40}{3}(13/15)^{39/2} < 1.$$

Both critical-point calculations follow from

$$\frac{d}{d\beta}\log\left((\beta-c)^{1/2}f(\beta)\right) = 0 \Longleftrightarrow 6-\beta = 39(\beta-c).$$

The interval $4/3 \leq \beta < 2$. Call a fiber heavy if $\ell_i > \sqrt{\beta-4/3}$. The projections of two heavy fibers cannot be at squared distance $4/3$, since that would violate (28). Their squared distance must be $2/3$, so there are at most 9 heavy fibers. There are at most 55 fibers altogether, giving

$$\tau s = M\tau + \sum_i \ell_i \leq 55\tau_0 + 46\sqrt{\beta-4/3} + 9\sqrt{\beta}.$$

For $4/3 \leq \beta < 3/2$, the bounds $\sqrt{5/9} < 3/4$ and $\sqrt{5} < 9/4$ yield

$$R < \frac{439}{4} f(4/3) < 1.$$

For $3/2 \leq \beta < 2$, the bounds $\sqrt{20/9} < 3/2$ and $\sqrt{20/3} < 8/3$ give

$$R < 148 f(3/2) < 1.$$

The remaining diameters. We always have $s_i \leq 1 + \sqrt{\beta}/\tau$, hence

$$R \leq M(1+\sqrt{10\beta/3})f(\beta).$$

Using (26) and rational upper bounds on the square roots gives:

Interval for β	Bound on M	Upper bound on R
$[2, 8/3)$	220	$880 f(2)$
$[8/3, 3)$	715	$(12155/4) f(8/3)$
$[3, 6)$	24310	$133705 f(3)$

Each value is strictly less than 1. All comparisons are verified exactly after squaring; for example,

$$2(39/40)^{39} < 1, \qquad (1600/9)(13/15)^{39} < 1.$$

The checks also verify that every resulting upper bound is at most $9(8/9)^{39/2}$. These cases cover every $\beta < 6$, completing the proof. □

This theorem covers an infinite family with unbounded determinant. It is not based on a bounded enumeration of lattices or clusters. An arbitrary rank-nine lattice without $\sqrt{3}E_8$, however, lies outside its scope.

9 All diameters for both minimal rank-ten types

Theorem 9.1. *For $K = K_{10}$ or $K = K_{10}^{\mathrm{alt}}$, every finite $S \subset K^*$ with $s > 1$ and $\beta < 6$ satisfies*

$$s(1-\beta/6)^{19} < 1.$$

Thus the singleton cluster is strictly optimal at the guaranteed radius of the antipode construction. The global classification in Theorem 6.2 makes this conclusion valid for every even integral rank-ten lattice of minimum at least 6 and determinant 54675.

9.1 Finite problems in the triangular fiber

The fiber in (25) has quadratic form

$$\|(u,v)\|_T^2 = \frac{2}{5}(u^2 - uv + v^2).$$

Its positive norms below $14/5$ are $2/5, 6/5, 8/5$. The maximum fiber-cluster cardinalities are:

Squared diameter interval	$[2/5, 6/5)$	$[6/5, 8/5)$	$[8/5, 14/5)$
Maximum cardinality	3	4	7

These assertions use small complete finite certificates. After translating one point to zero, the respective balls contain 7, 13, and 19 points. Contradicting the bounds would require choosing respectively 3, 4, and 7 other points. All

$$\binom{6}{3} = 20, \qquad \binom{12}{4} = 495, \qquad \binom{18}{7} = 31824$$

subsets are checked. No admissible set of a forbidden size occurs; witnesses of sizes 3, 4, and 7 are retained. Completeness of the balls follows from

$$2(u^2 - uv + v^2) \geq \frac{3}{2}u^2, \qquad 2(u^2 - uv + v^2) \geq \frac{3}{2}v^2 :$$

when the norm is below $14/5$, it suffices to examine all 49 pairs with $|u|, |v| \leq 3$. Distances are compared using the integer values $2(u^2 - uv + v^2)$.

9.2 Several fibers containing multiple points

Two points in one fiber and a point with another projection force

$$\beta \geq 2/3 + (2/5)/4 = 23/30.$$

This is the usual midpoint estimate: at least one endpoint of a segment of length at least $\sqrt{2/5}$ is vertically separated from any given point by at least half that length.

For two fibers containing multiple points, choose nonzero within-fiber differences $a, b \in T$. The four cross-fiber differences have the form $z + (\pm a \pm b)/2$. Comparing opposite pairs shows that the largest squared vertical distance is at least

$$\frac{1}{4}\max(\|a+b\|^2, \|a-b\|^2) \geq 3/10.$$

If either vector is not minimal, then $(\|a\|^2 + \|b\|^2)/4 \geq 2/5$. If both are minimal, they belong to the six roots of the triangular lattice and satisfy $|(a,b)| \geq 1/5$, giving $3/10$. All 36 root pairs are checked additionally.

Consequently, for the projections p, q of two fibers containing multiple points,

$$\beta \geq \|p-q\|^2 + 3/10. \tag{29}$$

For $\beta < 29/30$, at most one fiber contains multiple points. For $\beta < 49/30$, the projections of all such fibers are equidistant with squared distance $2/3$, so there are at most 9 of them, even if the entire projected set allows two distances.

9.3 A table covering every diameter

Combining the projected-set and fiber bounds gives the following upper bounds B on s. Every interval is closed at the left endpoint and open at the right endpoint.

Interval for β	B	Justification
$[2/5, 2/3)$	3	One projected point.
$[2/3, 23/30)$	9	Either every fiber is a singleton, or there is only one projected point.
$[23/30, 29/30)$	11	At most 9 projected points; one fiber may have 3 points.
$[29/30, 6/5)$	27	At most 9 fibers, each of size at most 3.
$[6/5, 4/3)$	36	At most 9 fibers, each of size at most 4.
$[4/3, 8/5)$	82	At most 55 fibers, including at most 9 nonsingleton fibers of size at most 4: $55 + 9 \cdot 3$.
$[8/5, 49/30)$	109	At most 55 fibers, including at most 9 nonsingleton fibers of size at most 7: $55 + 9 \cdot 6$.
$[49/30, 2)$	385	At most 55 fibers, each of size at most 7.
$[2, 8/3)$	1540	At most 220 fibers, each of size at most 7.
$[8/3, 6)$	54675	The cluster injects into K^*/K.

No nontrivial cluster exists for $\beta < 2/5$. For each row with left endpoint b, exact arithmetic gives

$$B^2(1 - b/6)^{38} < 1.$$

The function $(1 - \beta/6)^{19}$ decreases, so the required strict inequality holds throughout the interval. This proves Theorem 9.1 with no point cap, no restriction to diameter 1, and no cap on a search graph.

A separate, shorter table certificate is also completed for K_9, using a one-dimensional fiber of spacing $\sqrt{3/10}$. It now follows from the stronger Theorem 8.1; its independent availability gives an additional check of the fixed case.

9.4 Uniform density loss and the scope of the dimension-38 result

Corollary 9.2 (A uniform loss for nontrivial clusters)**.** *Let K be any even integral rank-ten lattice with $m(K) \geq 6$ and $d(K) = 54675$ and let $S \subset K^*$ be a finite set with $|S| > 1$ and squared diameter $\beta < 6$. At the guaranteed antipode radius $\sqrt{6 - \beta}/2$ in dimension 38, the ratio to the singleton construction over the same section, at radius $\sqrt{6}/2$, satisfies*

$$\frac{\delta(S, K)}{\delta(\{0\}, K)} = |S|(1 - \beta/6)^{19} \leq 9\left(\frac{8}{9}\right)^{19} = 0.9601621523027026\ldots < 1.$$

Thus every nontrivial cluster loses at least $3.9837847697297\ldots\%$ of this guaranteed center density. The numerical constant is a proved upper bound, not a claim of sharpness. By Theorem 6.2, this conclusion covers every determinant-minimal rank-ten section.

Proof. For each of the ten intervals in the all-diameter cluster table proving Theorem 9.1, write b for its included left endpoint and B for its cardinality bound. The pairs (b, B) are

$$(2/5, 3),\ (2/3, 9),\ (23/30, 11),\ (29/30, 27),\ (6/5, 36),$$

$$(4/3, 82),\ (8/5, 109),\ (49/30, 385),\ (2, 1540),\ (8/3, 54675).$$

On each interval, monotonicity gives $|S|(1 - \beta/6)^{19} \leq B(1 - b/6)^{19}$. Direct exact rational comparison of these ten numbers shows that the largest is $9(8/9)^{19}$, the value for $(b, B) = (2/3, 9)$. There are no nontrivial clusters below $\beta = 2/5$. □

Corollary 9.3 (Scope of the dimension-thirty-eight consequence)**.** *Let M be a positive-definite even unimodular lattice of rank 48 with minimum at least 6, and let $K \subset M$ be a primitive rank-ten section. At radius $\sqrt{6}/2$, the singleton construction from the orthogonal complement $N = M \cap K^{\perp}$ has center density*

$$\delta_0(K) = \frac{(3/2)^{19}}{\sqrt{\det K}} \leq \frac{(3/2)^{19}}{\sqrt{54675}}.$$

Equality in this guaranteed-radius comparison holds precisely when $\det K = 54675$*. By Theorem 6.2, every such section has the structure of Proposition 6.3, and every nontrivial cluster over it has the uniform loss just proved.*

Proof. Primitivity and unimodularity give $\det N = \det K$. The minimum of N is at least 6, and its rank is 38, so the stated radius gives the displayed center density. The determinant theorem yields the inequality. For a finite cluster, the usual unimodular gluing correspondence supplies one translate of N for each cluster point. Since $\beta < 6$, these are distinct modulo N: two cluster points in the same class modulo K would differ by a nonzero vector of K of norm at least 6. Ambient minimum at least 6 gives squared distance at least $6 - \beta$ between different translates. This proves the stated guaranteed-radius formula. □

These statements do not bound the actual density obtainable by increasing the radius when a particular orthogonal complement has minimum greater than 6, or when a particular cluster has better separation than $6 - \beta$. They do not compare nontrivial clusters over sections of larger determinant with the optimum singleton construction, and do not prove optimality among all sphere packings in dimension 38.

For ambient embeddings, the structural proposition shows that every optimal rank-ten section contains exactly three copies of K_9. Thus a global ambient classification can be organized by extending embeddings of K_9. The already verified catalogue of 19 supersections concerns only the fixed printed copy of K_9 in the printed P_{48p}; it is neither a catalogue of all optimal rank-ten sections in that ambient nor a count of ambient automorphism orbits.

Independent exact audit. The standard-library script `research_20261008/consequences/audit_two_types_and_cluster_gap.py` uses its own rational ellipsoid enumeration and matrix arithmetic. It checks all 6561 residue classes, transitivity of the 1920 deepest classes, the $560 + 1$ second-class orbits, and 559 explicit integral unimodular 10×10 Gram congruences connecting the large orbit. The ranks of the two Gram matrices modulo 3 are 4 and 3, so these two types cannot become isometric after forgetting the chosen E_8 copy. Direct dual enumeration finds exactly the six vectors of norm $2/5$ in each type, and each of the three kernel Gram matrices has determinant 21870, minimum 6, and 258 norm-six vectors. Finally, all ten uniform cluster comparisons are checked as rational inequalities.

10 Verified results for the rank-48 ambient lattices

10.1 Matrices of the original embeddings

The ambient Gram matrices of P_{48p} and P_{48m} and the matrices of their selected sections are extracted from the source PDF. With rows of T representing the section basis in ambient coordinates, the checks include

$$G_K = TG_{48}T^{\mathsf{T}}, \qquad TG_{48}B^{\mathsf{T}} = 0,$$

where the rows of B form a full integer basis of the orthogonal complement. Both ambient matrices are checked for symmetry, evenness, positive definiteness, and determinant 1. Primitivity of T is certified by a Smith normal form with every nonzero invariant factor equal to 1.

Section	Complement rank	Determinant	Invariants of A_K
$K_8 \subset P_{48p}$	40	6561	$3,3,3,3,3,3,3,3$
$K_9 \subset P_{48p}$	39	21870	$3,3,3,3,3,3,30$
$K_{10} \subset P_{48p}$	38	54675	$3,3,3,3,15,45$
$K_5 \subset P_{48m}$	43	3072	$4,16,48$
$K_3 \subset P_{48m}$	45	128	$2,8,8$

For each complement, the same determinant is verified and an explicit norm-six vector is retained. The assertion that the *entire* ambient lattice has minimum 6 remains an input from its known extremality. The new positivity and unimodularity checks alone do not exclude norms 2 and 4 in dimension 48.

For primitive $K \subset \Lambda$ with unimodular Λ, the natural pairing map $\Lambda \to K^*$ is surjective and has kernel $K^\perp \cap \Lambda$. Consequently,

$$\Lambda/(K \oplus K^\perp) \cong K^*/K, \qquad d(K^\perp) = d(K).$$

In the even case, the induced correspondence of discriminant groups reverses the signs of their quadratic forms. These correspondences are also verified for the printed matrices.

10.2 Excluding the alternative type over the fixed section

Theorem 10.1. *No isometric copy of K_{10}^{alt} in the printed lattice P_{48p} contains the particular printed section $K_9 \subset P_{48p}$.*

Fix the *specific marked* basis $t_1, \dots, t_9$ of the printed $K_9 \subset P_{48p}$. Consider the system

$$\|w\|^2 = 6, \qquad ((t_i, w))_{i=1}^{9} = (-p, -1). \tag{30}$$

A solution $w \in P_{48p}$ would extend this marked K_9 to precisely the block Gram matrix K_{10}^{alt} in (11).

The complete exact search for (30) reduces it to a closest-vector problem in an affine class of the rank-39 orthogonal complement. An independent Python implementation with unbounded integers and rational arithmetic visits 611239 nodes and finds no feasible leaf. The outcome agrees with the C++ implementation. No floating-point pruning is used in the final certificate.

As a positive control, the same algorithm is run for the pairing column of the original K_{10}. It visits 610015 nodes and finds exactly one vector, equal to the last row of the printed K_{10} embedding matrix.

Why the empty marked fiber excludes every copy over this K_9. Suppose a copy of K_{10}^{alt} contains the fixed K_9, and hence its fixed $J = \sqrt{3}E_8$. Its projection onto the two-dimensional orthogonal complement of J has minimum at least $10/3$ and determinant $25/3$. As in Theorem 4.1, it must be hexagonal. The projection z_1 of the fixed ninth vector has norm $10/3$, so it extends to an acute basis z_1, z_2 with matrix (13). Choose a shortest lift w of the second vector. It has full norm 6, and its J component has norm $8/3$. Primitivity of J and the fact that z_1, z_2 form a basis ensure that the fixed J basis, t_9, and w form a full integral basis of the copy of K_{10}^{alt}.

Let q' be the pairing column of w with the fixed basis of J. If q' and p are independent modulo 3, then the matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & p & q' \\ p^{\mathsf{T}} & 0 & c \\ (q')^{\mathsf{T}} & c & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

has rank 4 over $\mathbb{F}_3$. This contradicts the invariant $\operatorname{rank}_{\mathbb{F}_3} K_{10}^{\mathrm{alt}} = 3$. Hence $q' \equiv 0, p$, or $-p \pmod 3$. The zero class is impossible: its minimum is 0, whereas a lift of a minimal projected vector requires $8/3$. The class p is excluded by integrality of the full pairing: the J component contributes $8/3 \pmod{\mathbb{Z}}$, and the perpendicular component contributes $5/3$, giving the noninteger sum $13/3$.

Therefore $q' \equiv -p \pmod 3$. Since C is unimodular, this is equivalent to the discriminant class being the negative of that of the ninth vector. Subtracting a vector of J makes the J projection of w exactly the negative of the J projection of t_9. Its projected norm is still the same minimum $8/3$, so the full norm remains 6, and the pairing with t_9 becomes

$$-8/3 + 5/3 = -1.$$

This gives a solution of (30), contradicting its exact emptiness. The theorem follows without requiring a classification of bases or copies of E_8 inside K_9. □

10.3 Why the integer search is complete

Put $A = T_9 G_{48}$ and $b = (-p, -1)$. An integer right inverse Q gives a particular solution $w_0 = Qb$, while the certified integer kernel basis B gives every solution of the linear constraints:

$$w = w_0 + B^{\mathsf{T}} x, \qquad x \in \mathbb{Z}^{39}.$$

Set $C_0 = BG_{48}B^{\mathsf{T}}$, $g = BG_{48}w_0$, and $c = -C_0^{-1}g$. Exact computation gives

$$w_0^{\mathsf{T}} G_{48} w_0 - g^{\mathsf{T}} C_0^{-1} g = 7/2.$$

Thus the condition that the norm be at most 6 is equivalent to

$$(x - c)^{\mathsf{T}} C_0 (x - c) \le 5/2.$$

The exact factorization $C_0 = L\,\mathrm{diag}(D_i)L^{\mathsf{T}}$ rewrites the left-hand side as

$$\sum_i D_i \left(x_i + \sum_{j>i} L_{ji} x_j - y_i \right)^2, \qquad y = L^{\mathsf{T}} c.$$

Cauchy's inequality gives proven integer bounds $|x_i| \le B_i$, with

$$B_i \ge |c_i|, \qquad (B_i - |c_i|)^2 \ge (5/2)(C_0^{-1})_{ii}.$$

The largest bound B_i is 28.

The acceleration uses an *enclosing integer relaxation*, rather than trusting floating-point rounding. Set $S = 2^{24}$, round SL_{ji} and Sy_i to integers with error at most $1/2$, put $d_i = \lfloor SD_i \rfloor > 0$, and, for a fixed tail, define

$$C_i = \mathrm{round}(Sy_i) - \sum_{j>i} x_j\,\mathrm{round}(SL_{ji}), \qquad E_i = \left\lceil \frac{1 + \sum_{j>i} B_j}{2} \right\rceil.$$

The exact center differs from C_i/S by at most E_i/S. Hence each exact contribution is bounded below by

$$\frac{d_i}{S^3} \max(0, |Sx_i - C_i| - E_i)^2.$$

Every true solution must therefore lie in the relaxation

$$\sum_i d_i \max(0, |Sx_i - C_i| - E_i)^2 \le 5S^3/2.$$

With remaining integer budget R, an exact enclosing interval for the next coordinate is

$$|Sx_i - C_i| \le E_i + \mathrm{isqrt}(\lfloor R/d_i \rfloor).$$

Enumeration of all these intervals, clipped only by the proven B_i, gives no leaf even in the enlarged set; the original system is therefore empty. The independent Python verifier recomputes the kernel, factorization, coordinate bounds, and rounding bounds. The prepared coefficients are not accepted on trust.

Theorem 10.1 does **not** exclude every embedding $K_{10}^{\mathrm{alt}} \hookrightarrow P_{48p}$. A copy containing another section K_9 might lie in a different orbit of the ambient automorphism group. Those orbits are not fully enumerated. The verification of the printed matrices and this new exclusion have undergone an additional internal audit, but they do not constitute a complete embedding classification.

10.4 All 19 minimal supersections of the fixed K_9

Theorem 10.2. *In the printed lattice $\Lambda = P_{48p}$, there are exactly 19 distinct primitive rank-ten sublattices S containing the fixed printed K_9, with $d(S) = 54675$ and $m(S) \geq 6$. All 19 are isometric to the original K_{10}. This is the smallest possible determinant for supersections of this particular K_9.*

The number 19 counts *concrete sublattices in ambient coordinates*, not automorphism-group orbits. It concerns one fixed section K_9, rather than all embeddings of the abstract lattice.

Proof. Every such S contains the fixed $\sqrt{3}E_8$. Theorem 4.1 therefore gives the lower bound 54675 and a hexagonal projection in the equality case. Let $a = C^{-1}p \pmod 3$ be the class of the fixed ninth vector. The three classes $a, b, a - b$ of an acute projected basis are deep. Exactly 561 classes b satisfy this condition. The involution

$$b \longmapsto a - b$$

has the unique fixed point $b = -a$ and 280 two-element orbits. Thus 281 unoriented target classes suffice.

Choose a representative v of norm 8 in each class b, and put

$$q = Cv, \qquad t = (p^{\mathsf{T}}v + 5)/3, \qquad r_b = (q, t)^{\mathsf{T}}.$$

Integrality of t follows from the depth of $a - b$. Adding a vector of J to a closest lift makes its J-component exactly $v/3$. Every desired supersection therefore appears in one of the systems

$$T_9 G_{48} u = r_b, \qquad u^{\mathsf{T}} G_{48} u = 6, \qquad u \in \mathbb{Z}^{48}.$$

Direct verification gives $r_b^{\mathsf{T}} K_9^{-1} r_b = 7/2$ for every target. Each search consequently has residual squared norm $5/2$ in the same full rank-39 integer kernel and is covered by the enclosing integer relaxation proved above.

Complete enumeration of all 281 targets gives:

Exact search nodes	171472428
Empty target fibers	262
Fibers with a unique norm-6 vector	19
Total leaves and solutions	19

The singleton orbit $b = -a$ is empty; every solution has the original type K_{10}. The full Python verification with arbitrary-precision integers recomputes the rational prerequisites and every target search, comparing the node counts and vector lists with the C++ implementation. A separate generator from the rank-ten investigation produces the same set of 561 discriminant classes; equality of the sets is checked using exact fingerprints computed with the adjugate matrix.

It remains to certify that the count is of sublattices, not several generators of one sublattice. Choosing one representative of the pair $b, a - b$ removes the two acute orientations of the projected basis. For the other 560 oriented classes, the order in K_9^*/K_9 is 6. Opposite generators cannot have the same K_9-projection, because that would imply that twice the projection belongs to K_9. Generators with the same sign and the same projection also coincide.

A direct check in ambient coordinates supplies additional verification. For each solution u, the rows of $T_{10} = [T_9; u]$ have Smith form $[I_{10} \mid 0]$. Their lattice is therefore saturated and is the full section of its real span. With $d = 21870$, introduce the integer vector

$$N(u) = d\,u - T_9^{\mathsf{T}} \operatorname{adj}(K_9) r_b.$$

The vector $N(u)/d$ is the component perpendicular to the fixed K_9 and has squared norm $5/2$. Two supersection spans coincide if and only if their N vectors differ by sign, since all nonzero normal vectors

have the same length. The 19 vectors N are pairwise distinct up to sign. Thus there are exactly 19 distinct saturated sublattices. The catalogue stores the complete vector coordinates, Gram matrices, Smith forms, and normal vectors. □

This classification settles the problem of optimal supersections of *this particular* embedding of K_9. It does not determine how many of the 19 sections are equivalent under the stabilizer of K_9 in the ambient automorphism group, nor classify the other embedding orbits of K_9.

Theorems 10.1 and 10.2 do not use the global lower bound for $e_9(6)$ or its original large enumeration. Their inputs are the exact printed matrices and primitivity, the finite table of classes in $E_8/3E_8$, the elementary two-dimensional bound, and exhaustive searches in the specified affine fibers. Under the explicit hypothesis $m(S) \geq 6$, they also do not require a new proof that the whole ambient lattice has minimum 6; admissibility of the intrinsic matrices found is checked independently.

11 Literature, verification, and remaining problems

11.1 What the literature review establishes

Dutour Sikirić and van Woerden [3], version 2 of 7 February 2026, classify 2237251040 perfect similarity classes in rank nine and derive $\gamma_9 = 2$. Their work includes the known perfect class Q_{129} with 258 minimal vectors, connected with earlier work of Watson and also described in [9].

There is now an exact perfection certificate for our K_9: its 258 minimal vectors give 129 opposite pairs, whose symmetric outer products span a space of dimension

$$\dim \mathrm{Sym}_9 = 45.$$

An explicit 45×45 minor has determinant 3. Thus K_9 is a perfect form and belongs to the already known similarity class Q_{129} with this number of minimal vectors.

Accordingly, the lattice K_9 itself must not be presented as a new discovery of this investigation. The subject of a possible new paper is the global *even integral* determinant problem at minimum 6, completeness of its equality classification, and the additional results of this report. Perfection of one example does not prove global discrete optimality: an integral minimizer need not automatically be a perfect real quadratic form.

The review includes primary sources on integral laminated lattices [5, 8], the Martinet–Batut tables [6], and the classification of strongly perfect rank-ten lattices [7]. Their hypotheses differ: recursive lamination, catalogue examples, or strong perfection are not equivalent to an arbitrary even integral rank-ten lattice of minimum 6. No full solution to our global problem was found among the statements examined. Failure to find a reference is not a proof of novelty.

11.2 Reproduction map

All certificate paths in this paper are relative to the repository's `certificates/` directory unless explicitly stated otherwise. Use ordinary Python 3 with assertions enabled; do not use `-O` or `-OO`. The original exact package is in `research_20261007/recovered/`. The companion full English rank-nine theory is available in that directory under `rank9_audit_evidence_20260910/manuscripts/rank9_audit_theory_EN.txt` and the matching PDF. The `.txt` file is compilable LaTeX.

Claim	Main verifier
New windows and uniqueness of K_9	`research_20261007/equality/verify_equality.py`
Gap through determinant 24450	`research_20261007/equality/rank9_gap.py`
Independent endpoint certificates and isometries	`research_20261007/independent_review/check_equality_independent.py`
Perfection of K_9	`research_20261007/independent_review/check_k9_perfect.py`
Rank-ten subclass and its two types	`research_20261007/rank10/verify_rank10_e8_classification.py`
Preliminary lower bound 31595	`research_20261007/rank10_theory/verify_rank10_bounds.py`
Exact global value $e_{10}(6)$	`research_20261007/rank10/verify_global_rank10_certificate.py`
Independent full chain	`research_20261007/independent_review/check_rank10_global_chain.py`
Independent low rank-nine interval	`research_20261007/independent_review/check_rank9_low_by_radius.py`
First three determinants and the no-$\sqrt{3}E_8$ case	`research_20261007/rank10/verify_rank9_low_spectrum.py`
Uniform partial rank-ten cluster bounds	`research_20261007/clusters/verify_rank10_single_projection.py`
Fixed-section clusters of all diameters	`research_20261007/clusters/verify_fixed_section_cluster_optimality.py`
Every rank-nine section with $\sqrt{3}E_8$	`research_20261007/clusters/verify_all_E8_rank9_cluster_optimality.py`
Printed embeddings and complements	`research_20261007/embeddings/verify_ambient_embeddings.py`
Marked extension and positive control	`research_20261007/embeddings/verify_A10_extension_exact.py`
All 19 supersections of the fixed K_9	`research_20261007/embeddings/verify_all_fixed_K9_extensions.py`

JSON tables and complete logs accompany the programs. Checksums certify file integrity, not mathematical completeness. Completeness is established by exact determinant windows, finite groups of the required order, exhaustive ball enumeration with rational bounds, orbit trees, and explicit unimodular isometries.

The original enumeration in lower ranks and its corrections are discussed in detail in the audit of 10 September 2026 [1]. The new window and orbit computations were executed afresh in the recorded investigation. The independent check of 262 endpoints uses a different mathematical procedure, and independent integer matrix products verify the isometries. The complete rank-ten orbit enumeration reuses the audited exact arithmetic module of the original package. This must be distinguished from an entirely independent second implementation of the whole original proof.

The cluster bounds are verified by a separate standard-library Python program. Their main content is a

geometric proof; computation certifies only the small finite fibers and rational inequalities. Internal review notes on uniqueness, rank ten, and the cluster arguments are included in the package.

The equality-boundary and structural verifiers have the following paths relative to `certificates/`:

- `research_20261008/independent_review/check_equality_windows_and_recovered_prunes.py`;
- `research_20261008/independent_review/check_boundaries_by_quadratic_module.py`;
- `research_20261008/consequences/audit_two_types_and_cluster_gap.py`.

The first two extend the complete strict-search certificate to the equality window. The third independently verifies the two types, their intrinsic sublattices, and the quantitative cluster comparison. All use exact arithmetic. Run them with assertions enabled; the finite-module checker accepts `--workers 2`.

11.3 The precise remaining work

1. **Embeddings.** Classify the primitive-embedding orbits of K_9, K_{10}, and K_{10}^{alt} in the selected rank-48 lattices. The catalogue of 19 minimal supersections of one fixed K_9 does not classify the other embeddings or ambient orbits.
2. **The P_{48m} question.** Resolve the section-existence question of Remark 2 in [2]. The absence of a suitable order-three automorphism, even if certified, would not by itself exclude other embeddings.
3. **Clusters outside the settled family.** Study rank-nine sections without $\sqrt{3}E_8$, mixed clusters with noncollinear fibers and the remaining diameters for rank-ten sections of larger determinant, as well as other ranks, especially the construction in dimension 43. The actual radius in a particular ambient embedding is a separate possible direction.
4. **External review.** Submit the precise statements, programs, completeness proofs, and external assumptions to a specialist. Parallel internal auditing is not external refereeing.
5. **Novelty.** Compare the discrete integral theorem against the full available literature and catalogues. The attaining example K_9 is already identified with a known perfect class; the title and introduction of a future paper should preserve that distinction.

A Additional uniform rank-ten cluster bounds

The following results apply to an even integral rank-ten lattice K of *any determinant*, with $m(K) \geq 6$, containing $J \cong \sqrt{3}E_8$. They supplement Theorem 9.1, but do not establish optimality for all clusters throughout this family.

A.1 Normalization and planar-fiber geometry

The sublattice J is automatically primitive. Let P be the projection of K onto $(\operatorname{span}_{\mathbb{R}} J)^{\perp}$, and put

$$T = P^* = K^* \cap (\operatorname{span}_{\mathbb{R}} J)^{\perp}, \qquad V = \operatorname{covol}(T).$$

Subtracting a nearest representative in J from a lift of a nonzero vector of P, and using $R_J = 8/3$, gives

$$m(P) = m(T^*) \geq c := 10/3.$$

Since $d(K) = 6561 d(P) = 6561/V^2$, the ratio of the guaranteed center density to that of the singleton packing of determinant 54675 is

$$R = \frac{5}{\sqrt{3}} V s\, g(\beta), \qquad g(\beta) = (1 - \beta/6)^{19}. \tag{31}$$

Again, s is the number of cluster points and $\beta < 6$ is its squared diameter.

Let a be the length of a primitive vector of T along a lattice line. The primitive vector of T^* perpendicular to that line has length a/V: in a basis beginning with this vector of T, the height of the second basis vector is V/a. Consequently,

$$\frac{V}{a} \leq \frac{1}{\sqrt{c}}. \tag{32}$$

In particular, this holds for a shortest nonzero vector of T.

A.2 All clusters with a single projection

Proposition A.1. *If a nontrivial finite cluster $S \subset K^*$ lies entirely in one fiber of the projection onto J^*, then $R < 1$. This holds uniformly over all determinants of K and all $\beta < 6$.*

Proof. The fiber is a translate of the planar lattice T. First suppose that the cluster points are collinear, and let a be the primitive spacing along their line. A segment containing them has length at least $(s-1)a$ and at most $\sqrt{\beta}$. Using (32), we obtain

$$sV \leq \frac{s}{s-1}\sqrt{\beta/c} \leq 2\sqrt{\beta/c}, \qquad R \leq \sqrt{10\beta}\, g(\beta).$$

The right-hand side attains its maximum on $(0, 6)$ at $\beta = 2/13$. The square of this maximum is

$$\frac{20}{13}\left(\frac{38}{39}\right)^{38} < 1.$$

The critical-point equation is $6 - \beta = 38\beta$, and the last comparison is verified exactly.

For a noncollinear cluster, we use the following elementary area bound:

$$sV \leq \frac{8}{3}\beta. \tag{33}$$

We prove it as follows. After translating the fiber to T, let C be the convex hull of the cluster, and set $N = |C \cap T| \geq s$. Adding all lattice points of the hull does not increase its diameter, which is at most $\sqrt{\beta}$.

Write I and B for the numbers of interior and boundary lattice points, respectively, so that $N = I + B$. Pick's theorem, after a change of coordinates from T to $\mathbb{Z}^2$, states that

$$\frac{\text{area}(C)}{V} = I + \frac{B}{2} - 1 \geq \frac{N-2}{2}.$$

Hence

$$NV \leq \frac{2N}{N-2}\,\text{area}(C).$$

If $N = 3$, the hull is a triangle of diameter at most $\sqrt{\beta}$, so its area is at most $\sqrt{3}\beta/4$. Thus $NV \leq 3\sqrt{3}\beta/2 < 8\beta/3$.

If $N = 4$, the hull is a triangle or a quadrilateral. Its area is at most $\beta/2$: for a quadrilateral, the area is half the magnitude of the cross product of its diagonals, both of which have length at most $\sqrt{\beta}$. Thus $NV \leq 2\beta < 8\beta/3$.

If $N \geq 5$, the planar isodiametric inequality bounds the area of a set of diameter d by $\pi d^2/4$. Therefore,

$$NV \leq \frac{N\pi}{2(N-2)}\beta \leq \frac{5\pi}{6}\beta < \frac{8}{3}\beta,$$

where $\pi < 16/5$ suffices. This proves (33). The constant $8/3$ is deliberately not optimized.

Substituting (33) into (31) gives

$$R \leq \frac{40}{3\sqrt{3}}\,\beta g(\beta).$$

The maximum is attained at $\beta = 3/10$ and equals

$$\frac{4}{\sqrt{3}}\left(\frac{19}{20}\right)^{19} < 1, \qquad \frac{16}{3}\left(\frac{19}{20}\right)^{38} < 1$$

after squaring. This completes both cases. □

Pick's theorem and the isodiametric inequality are used here as classical exact geometric theorems; numerical checks do not replace them. A singleton cluster is treated separately: $d(K) \geq 54675$ already gives $R \leq 1$.

A.3 Multiple projections with collinear fibers

Proposition A.2. *Suppose that $S \subset K^*$ has at least two distinct projections onto J^*, that $\beta < 4/3$, and that every fiber containing more than one cluster point is collinear. The lines in different fibers may have different directions. Then*

$$R \leq C_{\text{col}} < 1,$$

where the exact upper bound used is

$$C_{\text{col}} = \sqrt{1620 \cdot \frac{16}{117}\left(\frac{304}{351}\right)^{38}} = 0.969365242080\ldots.$$

Proof. The number M of projections satisfies $2 \leq M \leq 9$, and $\beta \geq 2/3$. If all fibers are singletons, then $s = M \leq 9$ and $d(K) \geq 54675$ give

$$R \leq 9(8/9)^{19} < 1.$$

This bound is also smaller than the stated numerical bound.

Otherwise, put $a = \sqrt{m(T)}$, and let $t \geq u$ be the two largest fiber cardinalities. Then $t \geq 2$, $u \geq 1$, and $s \leq t + (M-1)u$. A collinear fiber containing s_i points has diameter $d_i \geq (s_i - 1)a$.

Averaging the squares of the four cross distances between the endpoints of two segments gives a contribution in the perpendicular plane of at least $(d_i^2 + d_j^2)/4$. The angle between the fiber lines cancels in the average, so parallelism is not required. Including the distance between their projections gives

$$\beta \geq \frac{2}{3} + \frac{d_i^2 + d_j^2}{4}, \qquad a^2\big((t-1)^2 + (u-1)^2\big) \leq 4\Delta, \qquad \Delta = \beta - \frac{2}{3}.$$

For integers $t \geq u \geq 1$ with $t \geq 2$, we have

$$\frac{t + (M-1)u}{\sqrt{(t-1)^2 + (u-1)^2}} \leq \max(M+1, \sqrt{2}M) \leq 9\sqrt{2}. \tag{34}$$

Indeed, put $x = t - 1 \geq y = u - 1 \geq 0$. If $y = 0$, the ratio is $(M + x)/x \leq M + 1$. If $y \geq 1$, set $r = x/y \geq 1$; the ratio is at most

$$\frac{2M - 1 + r}{\sqrt{1 + r^2}}.$$

Its derivative has the sign of $1 - (2M - 1)r < 0$ for $M \geq 2$ and $r \geq 1$, so its maximum is $\sqrt{2}M$, attained at $r = 1$.

Equations (32), (34), and (31) imply

$$R \leq 18\sqrt{5\Delta}\,(1 - \beta/6)^{19}.$$

The right-hand side attains its maximum when

$$6 - \beta = 38(\beta - 2/3), \qquad \beta = \frac{94}{117}, \qquad \Delta = \frac{16}{117}.$$

Its square is $1620(16/117)(304/351)^{38} < 1$, as verified by exact rational arithmetic. □

A.4 Scope and certificate

Proposition A.1 covers all single-fiber clusters for every $\beta < 6$ and every determinant. Proposition A.2 adds clusters with multiple collinear fibers when $\beta < 4/3$. These proofs do not exclude mixed clusters with a noncollinear planar fiber, or general clusters with multiple fibers and larger diameter. Summing the single-fiber bound alone is insufficient.

These two results use the finite class table of $E_8/3E_8$, primitive planar dual spacing, and elementary geometry. They do not require the global lower bound for $e_9(6)$, the theorem $\gamma_9 = 2$, or the large flag enumeration. The exact comparisons, critical points, and constants are checked by `research_20261007/clusters/verify_rank10_single_projection.py`; its JSON certificate and log accompany it.

References and source materials

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